DIPARTIMENTO DI INFORMATICA - SCIENZA E INGEGNERIA

To Whom It May Concern

I have known Pietro Bertozzi for the past two years in my capacity as a professor at the University of Bologna and it is my pleasure to write this recommendation letter.

I first met Pietro through CyberChallenge.IT, the Italian national cybersecurity training program organized by the CINI Cybersecurity National Lab. He was selected to participate as a student in 2024, playing a key role in lifting the University of Bologna team to the podium in the final competition among 40+ universities. He was then appointed as a cryptography trainer in 2025, contributing to the preparation of the team and accompanying it to the national finals to replicate the great outcome. I particularly value students who, after benefiting from an educational opportunity, are willing to return and contribute to the experience of those who follow them.

Pietro's dedication to build a shared learning space was not isolated to those episodes. He was active with the Unibo Lab of Information and System Security (Ulisse) CTF Team, where he taught introductory sessions, organized Ulisse CTF 2025 - the team's first independently organized competition and part of the national CyberCup.IT circuit, and helped new members take over the group's regular training sessions.

During the 2025/2026 academic year, Pietro worked as a tutor for "Cybersecurity: from design to operations", the professional Master's program I direct, handling organizational and administrative tasks and providing tech support to participants and instructors. He approached his responsibilities with sound judgment and a level of autonomy that made him someone I could rely on. He also encouraged some participants to apply as tutors for the following year.

Pietro also served as a student representative. In that capacity, he voiced his constituency's concerns before the degree program council, with a respectful and constructive attitude that favored the adoption of the most appropriate actions.

The different tasks Pietro faced show one common trait that goes beyond the undeniable technical and relational skills he employed for their successful completion. In my experience, it is rare to find students who so consistently take responsibility not only for their own contributions, but also for the people and activities that will remain after their involvement ends. Many students are willing to help when asked, and some take the initiative to contribute beyond what is required of them. Far fewer show the same concern, across different settings, to give back to the community that helped them succeed and for ensuring that others are able to carry the work forward.

These qualities have earned him my trust, and I would be very pleased to work with him again. I recommend him with great confidence for future academic or professional opportunities.

Faithfully yours,
Marco Prandini, Ph. D.
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